

BIRDS

Any animal that grows feathers is a bird. Some are bigger than people; others are almost as small as bees. Birds hatch out of eggs, which are kept in a nest. All birds have feathers and wings, even the ones that do not fly.



Blue-tit
nest

Because they have no teeth, birds cannot chew. Instead, they grind food in a gizzard. Some food stays in a storage bag called a crop so it can be coughed up later for chicks to eat! Birds are like us in the way they breathe oxygen into their lungs. However, they appeared long before humans.



Birds are descended from small, feathered, meat-eating dinosaurs with long arms that could be used as wings. This means that all 10,000 different types of birds that live here with us on Earth are actually living dinosaurs!



Parrot
feathers



Budgerigar feathers



Owl
feather



Green-winged
parrot skeleton